

“A CONSTITUTION IS ONLY A MEANS TO AN END… WHEN BY WORKING TOGETHER AS A TEAM, VARIOUS PARTIES REALIZE THAT THE ENDS ARE COMMON, THERE WILL BE LITTLE DIFFICULTY IN AGREEING UPON THE MEANS.”

Born in present-day Karnataka, **BN Rau** was a brilliant student who successfully qualified for a position in the Indian Civil Service. Renowned for his knowledge of constitutional law, Rau was appointed Constitutional Advisor to the Drafting Committee in 1946. He travelled across the world to study other countries’ constitutions and consult with local lawyers and judges on constitutional issues. Based on his research, he prepared an entire draft constitution that deeply influenced the thinking and approach of the Assembly. Ambedkar himself stated that at least part of the credit for the framing of the Constitution must go to Rau (who was not actually a member of the Assembly himself).

Much of the day-to-day administration of British India was undertaken by Indian Civil Service men. A post in the ICS brought influence and perks, and was much sought after. From 1853, anyone who could pass the exams could secure a post—including Indians.